

UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX

Undergraduate Examinations 2020

Current Disputes in Sociology: Sociological Analysis III

Time allowed: 24 hours

Please see your exam timetable or check on FASER for the deadline to upload your answer.

The times shown on your timetable are in British Summer Time (BST). Please check online for a conversion to your local time if you will be undertaking your assessment outside the United Kingdom

INSTRUCTIONS

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions: **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B** and **ONE** from **EITHER** Section.

The paper consists of **SIXTEEN** questions in total.

All questions are of equal weight.

You may write up to 2250 words for this paper, a suggested 750 per question.

These questions have been set so that you can answer them within the normal exam time frame which is three hours. You are not expected to spend 24 hours on this assessment.

Referencing and plagiarism

You may consult resources for this take-home exam. You are NOT expected to provide a bibliography.

You must avoid copying from text books, articles, online sources or your own previous work. If you do quote, you must use quotation marks and provide in-text references. Penalties for plagiarism will apply.

You are reminded that collaborating with other students is collusion, which is also an academic offence. Penalties will apply.

Submission

If you have a query with the content of this exam paper contact socugrad@essex.ac.uk

If you have a technical problem with FASER, or any other query, please go to [Exams Website](#) to find contact details of the teams that can help you.

Please note that the time allocated for this assessment includes time for you to download this question and answer paper and to upload your question and answers paper to FASER.

Please allow at least 30 minutes at the end of your exam time to upload your work. Once you have completed the assessment do not leave it to the last minute to upload.

Please save your work throughout the examination to avoid losing your work. **You must only submit Microsoft Word documents.**

Please do not communicate with any other candidate in any way during this assessment. Your response must be your own work. Procedures are in place to detect plagiarism and collusion.

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions: **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B** and **ONE** from **EITHER** Section.

SECTION A

1. Outline and assess the view that facts are the foundation of sociological analysis.
2. “It is not facts but meanings which are the foundation of sociological analysis”. Critically analyse this statement.
3. “Most Western sociological accounts of modernity have been ‘euro-centric’”. Explain this statement and then assess its validity.
4. “Language is not innocent and requires sociological analysis”. Critically analyse this statement.
5. What did Barthes mean when he argued that myths are to be found throughout contemporary society? How convincing do you find his approach?
6. Why did Bourdieu think that cultural capital was key to understanding contemporary society? Was he right?
7. Outline and assess the arguments of writers such as Collini, Savage and Williams as to why the rich have got richer over the last 30 years.
8. Why have some feminists argued that gender is always “intersectional”
9. Do feminist epistemologists reject the notion of objectivity?

END OF SECTION A

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions: **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B** and **ONE** from **EITHER** Section.

SECTION B

10. Outline and assess Foucault's view that power is productive.
11. "One ever feels his 'twoness'". What did Du Bois mean by this statement?
12. Using the work of Stuart Hall and at least one other writer, explain what is meant by the phrase "The West and the Rest".
13. Critically examine the links between power and vision.
14. One aim of feminism was to move away from analyses of the natural body. Why have some writers, such as Butler, recently argued that there is a need to return to thinking about the body?
15. "'Man' and 'Woman' are not binary opposites'. Critically explain the importance of this statement.
16. "By ignoring the role of animals in society, sociology has not been able to develop a full understanding of the social world today". Critically analyse this statement.

END OF SECTION B

END OF QUESTION PAPER
PLEASE SEE NEXT PAGE FOR THE ANSWER SHEET

ANSWER SHEET
(Please use as many sheets as you need to)

Student Registration Number:

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TYPE THE QUESTION NUMBERS AND YOUR ANSWERS HERE: